The Boys Carol
Personent Hodie

14th Century tune (Piae Cantiones, 1582)
Translation from Elizabeth Poston's Penguin Book of Christmas Carols

Drumming: 4 beat lead in; quiet drumming throughout

1a. Personent hodie,
Voces puerulae,
Laudantes jocunde,
Qui nobis est natus,
Summo Deo datus,
Et de vir, vir, vir,
Et de vir, vir, vir,
Et de virginneo
Ventre procreatus.

1b. Let the boys' cheerful noise,
Sing today none but joys,
Praise aloud, clear and proud,
Praise to him in chorus,
Giv'n from heaven for us,
Virgin-born, born, born,
Virgin-born, born, born,
Virgin-born on that morn,
Procreated for us.

2. He who rules heaven and earth
Lies in stall at his birth,
Humble beasts at his feast
See the Light eternal
Vanquish realms infernal:
Satan's done, done, done,
Satan's done, done, done,
Satan's done, God has won,
Victor he, supernal.

3. Magi come from afar
See their sun, tiny one,
Follow far, little star,
At the crib adoring,
Man to God restoring,
Gold and myrrh, myrrh, myrrh,
Gold and myrrh, myrrh, myrrh,
Gold and myrrh offered there,
Incense for adoring.

4. Clerk and boy, join in joy,
Sing as heaven sings for joy,
God this day here doth stay,
Pour we forth the story
Of his might and glory:
Ideo, o, o,
Ideo, o, o,
Ideo gloria
In excelsis Deo.

Piae Cantiones, a book of Latin carols compiled in Finland in 1582, gives us The Boys' Carol, with a translation of the original text from Elizabeth Poston's Penguin Book of Christmas Carols. [Notes from Nowell Sing We Clear.]